Creating Your First Table

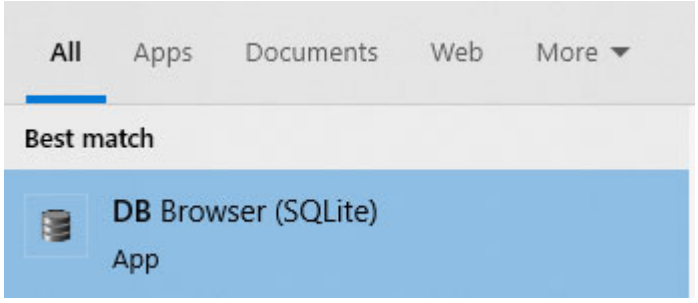
To get you started, we'll walk you through creating your first table in this section. The table will be named "Person" and will store basic information about people. In a later section we'll have you connect to your database and start working with data in the table.

Step 1: Launching DB Browser for SQLite

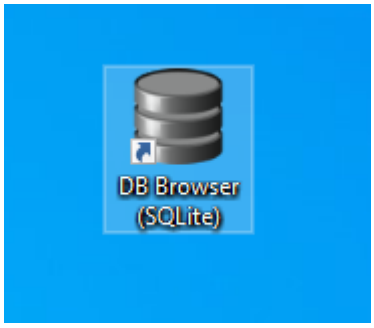
Launch from Windows

You can launch DB Browser for SQLite from Windows, either from the Start Menu, or from the shortcut on the desktop, as shown in the below screenshots.

Start Menu



Desktop

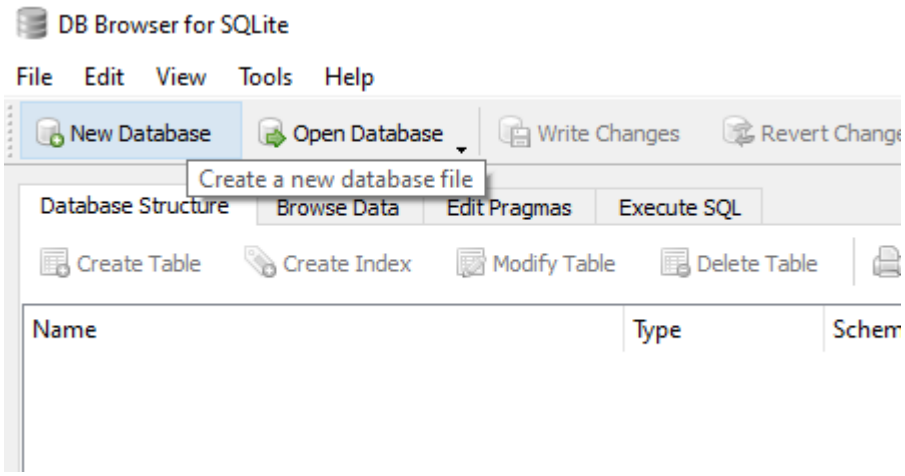


Step 2: Create a New Database

The first thing you need to do after launching the application is create a SQLite database, which will house the tables and other objects you want to work with.

Click New Database

To get started, click the “New Database” button in the top left, as shown below.



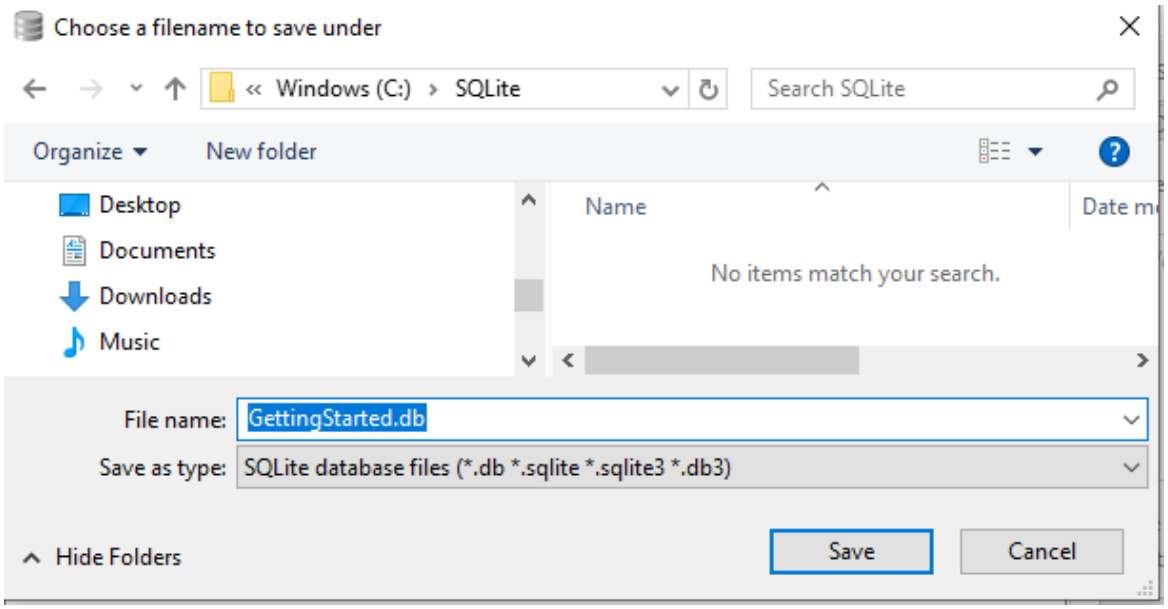
Determine Path

Now you need to choose a folder and filename. It may be necessary to create a folder to keep the database in a place you can remember.

In our example, we have created “C:\SQLite” as the folder, because it is a common location that is easy to remember. Later when you’re developing within the context of your application, you might choose to save your database as part of your Java project. In the real world, the database is commonly saved in its own subdirectory in a source code repository for the project.

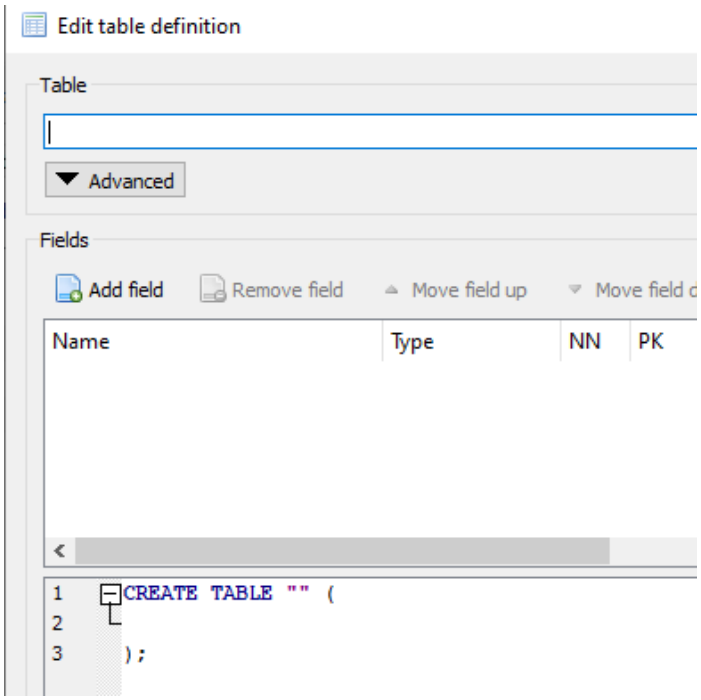
We entered “GettingStarted.db” as the filename. The “GettingStarted” name helps us know it’s for this getting started tutorial. The “.db” file extension is one of the accepted extensions for SQLite files. There are a few other accepted extensions as well; however, “.db” appears to be the most common.

This is shown in the screenshot below.



Close Table Definition Screen

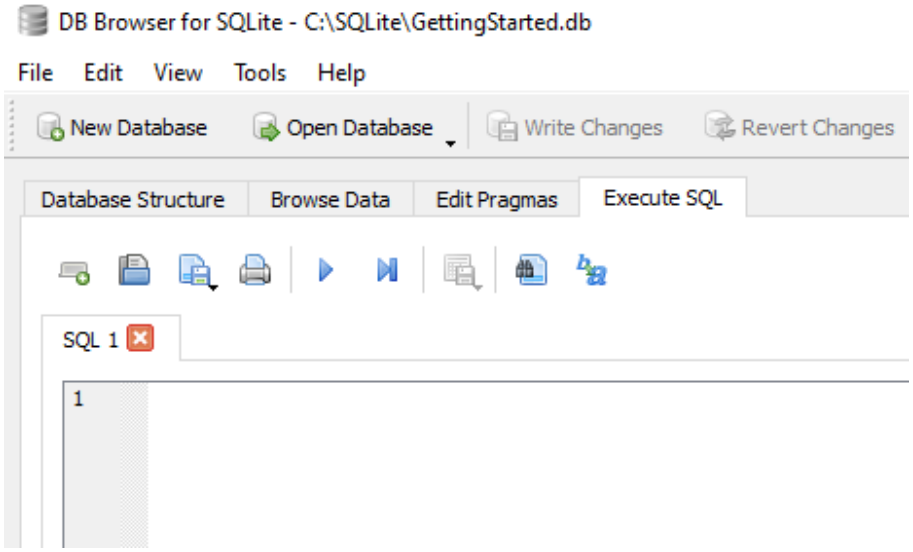
Immediately after clicking the "Save" button to create the database, a window pops up that lets us define tables using a wizard.



Simply close this window, as we will be typing in SQL directly.

Select Execute SQL Tab

We want to type the CREATE TABLE command in SQL, so we need to click on the "Execute SQL" tab first, as shown below.

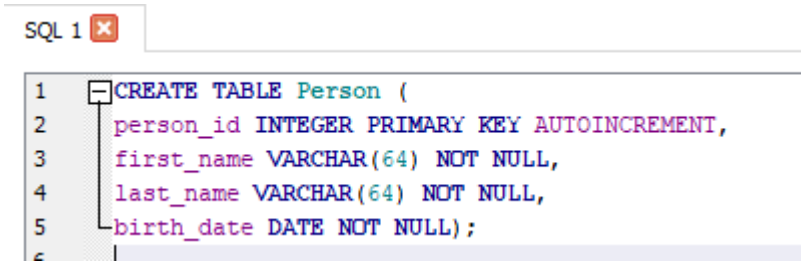


Create Table

Next, we type the command to create the table. Type this command exactly:

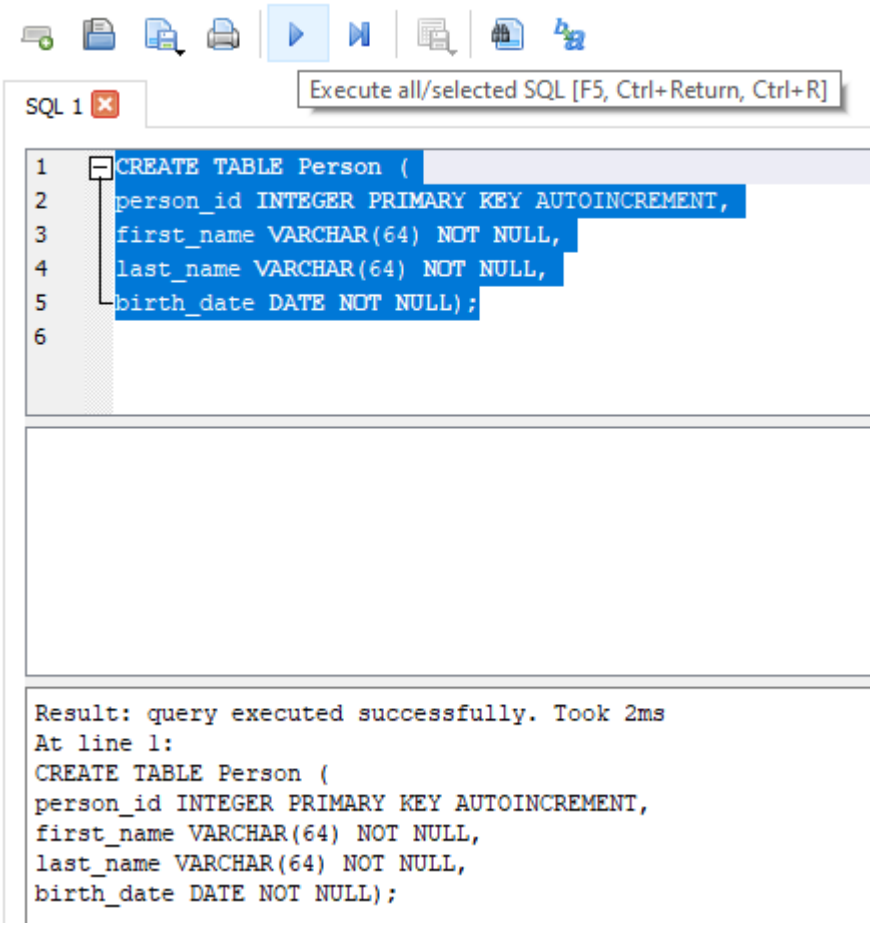
```
CREATE TABLE Person (
person_id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,
first_name VARCHAR(64) NOT NULL,
last_name VARCHAR(64) NOT NULL,
birth_date DATE NOT NULL);
```

This is shown below.



This command creates a table named "Person" with a person_id autoincrementing field, first and last name fields, and a birth date field.

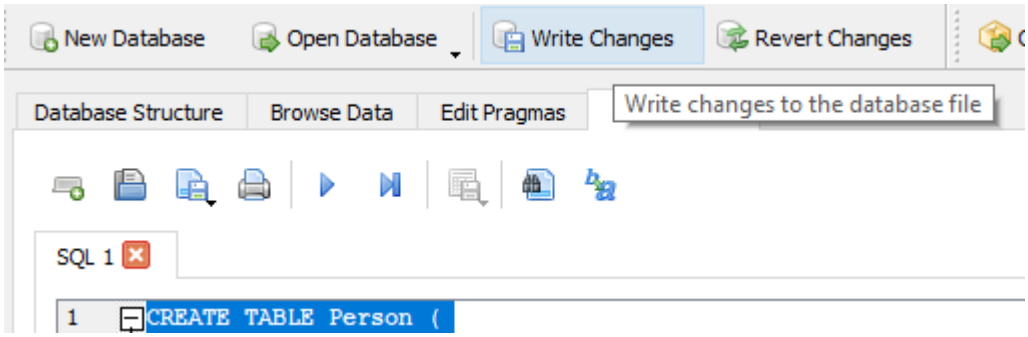
Next click the “Execute all/selected SQL” button, which looks like . After you have done so, a message will appear stating that the table has been created. This is all shown below.



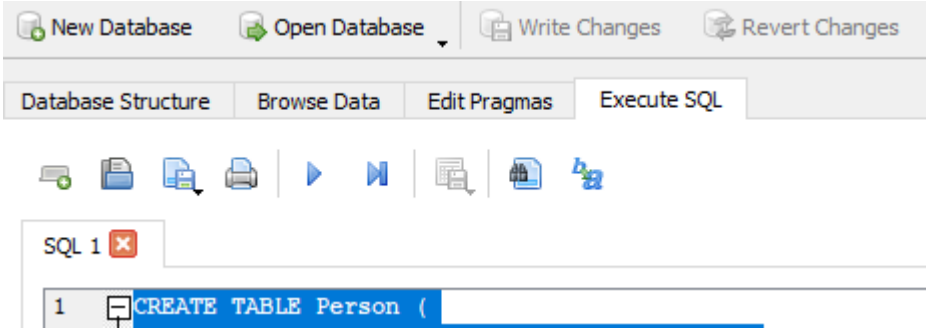
You can see that your person table was successfully created!

Save Changes

In order to save the changes to the database file, you need to click the “Write Changes” button, as shown below.



Once you have done so, the button will gray out, indicating there is nothing more to save.



You can determine if any changes need to be saved by looking at these buttons to see if they are clickable, or grayed out.

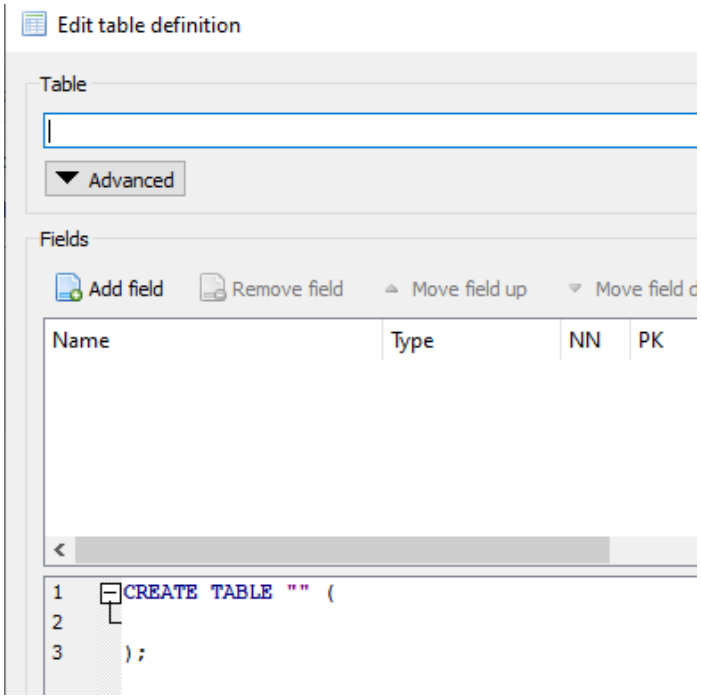
Database Ready for Application

Congratulations! You've created a SQLite database and added a table to it. The database is now ready for an application to connect to it and work with person data, which we'll do in the next section.

Step 3: Adding a Table

Close Table Definition Screen

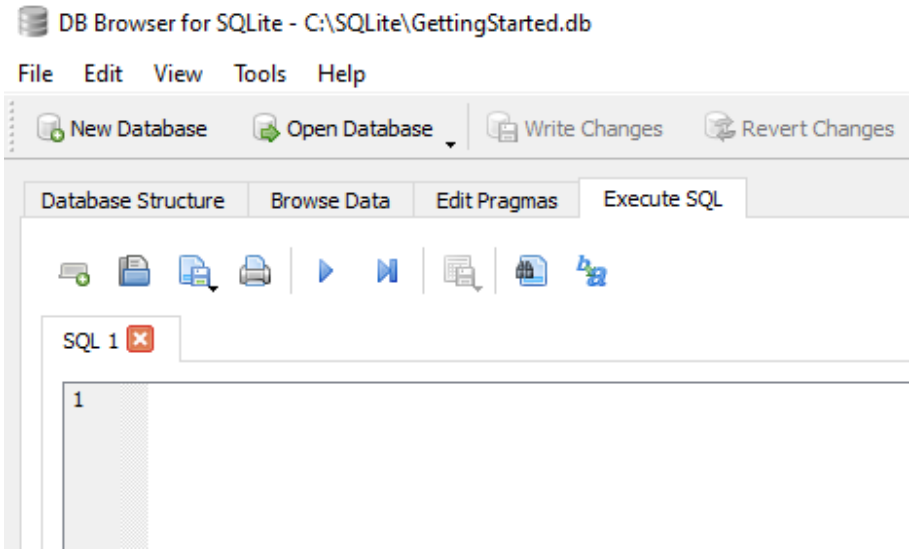
Immediately after clicking the "Save" button to create the database, a window pops up that lets us define tables using a wizard.



Simply close this window, as we will be typing in SQL directly.

Select Execute SQL Tab

We want to type the CREATE TABLE command in SQL, so we need to click on the "Execute SQL" tab first, as shown below.

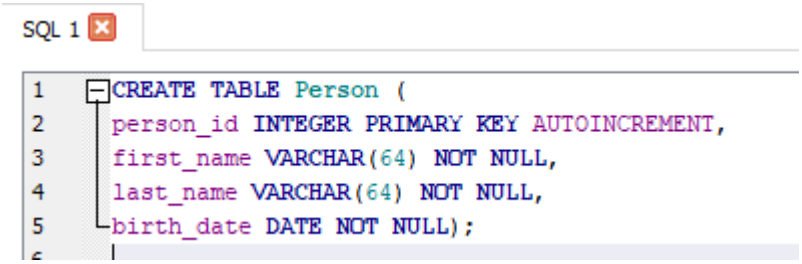


Create Table

Next, we type the command to create the table. Type this command exactly:

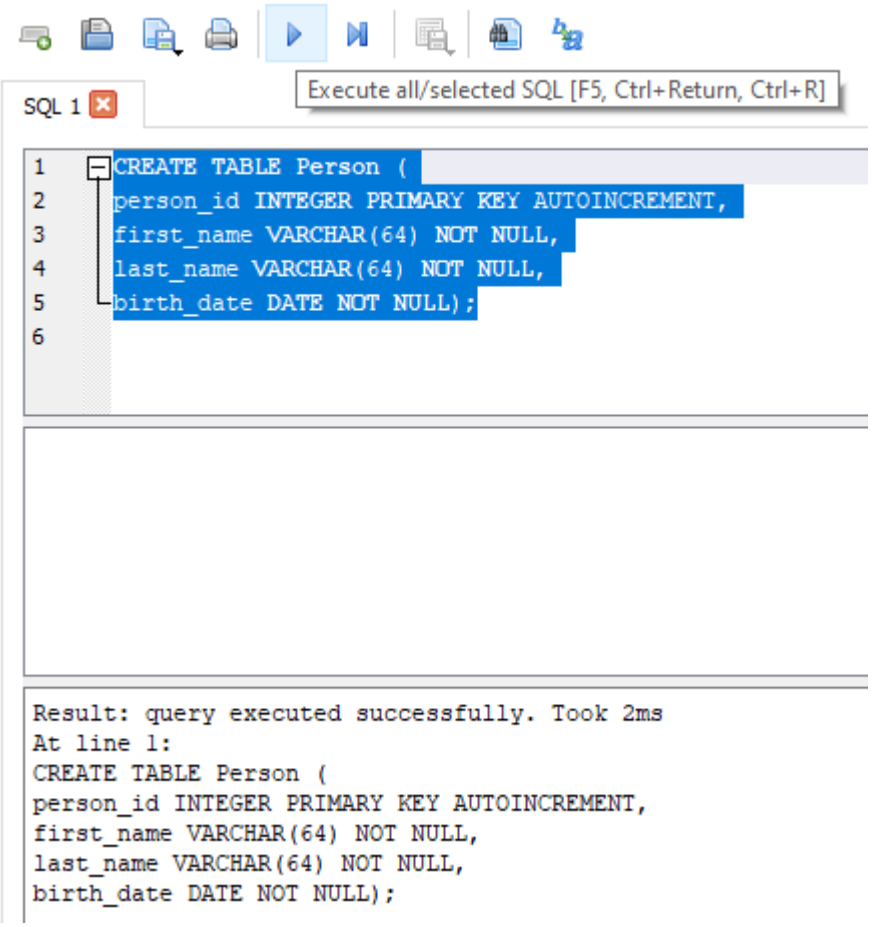
```
CREATE TABLE Person (
person_id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,
first_name VARCHAR(64) NOT NULL,
last_name VARCHAR(64) NOT NULL,
birth_date DATE NOT NULL);
```

This is shown below.



This command creates a table named “Person” with a person_id autoincrementing field, first and last name fields, and a birth date field.

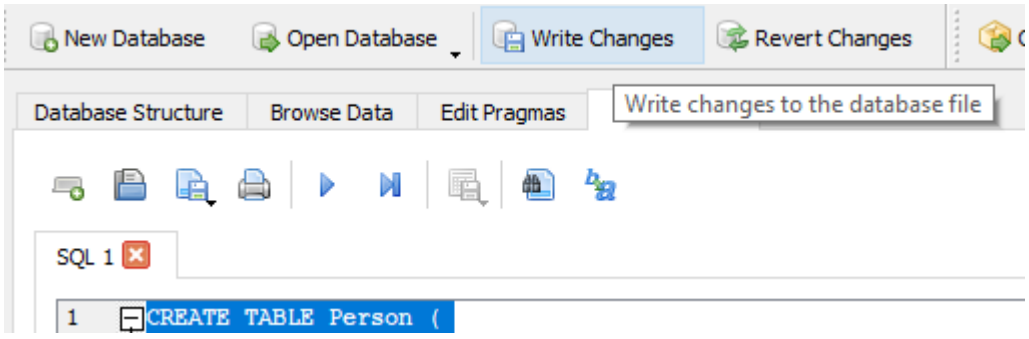
Next click the “Execute all/selected SQL” button, which looks like . After you have done so, a message will appear stating that the table has been created. This is all shown below.



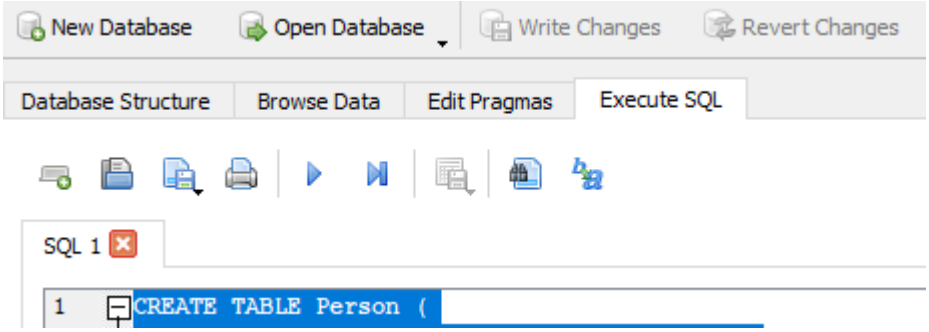
You can see that your person table was successfully created!

Save Changes

In order to save the changes to the database file, you need to click the “Write Changes” button, as shown below.



Once you have done so, the button will gray out, indicating there is nothing more to save.



You can determine if any changes need to be saved by looking at these buttons to see if they are clickable, or grayed out.

Database Ready for Application

Congratulations! You've created a SQLite database and added a table to it. The database is now ready for an application to connect to it and work with person data, which we'll do in the next section.